



Characteristics of Communication

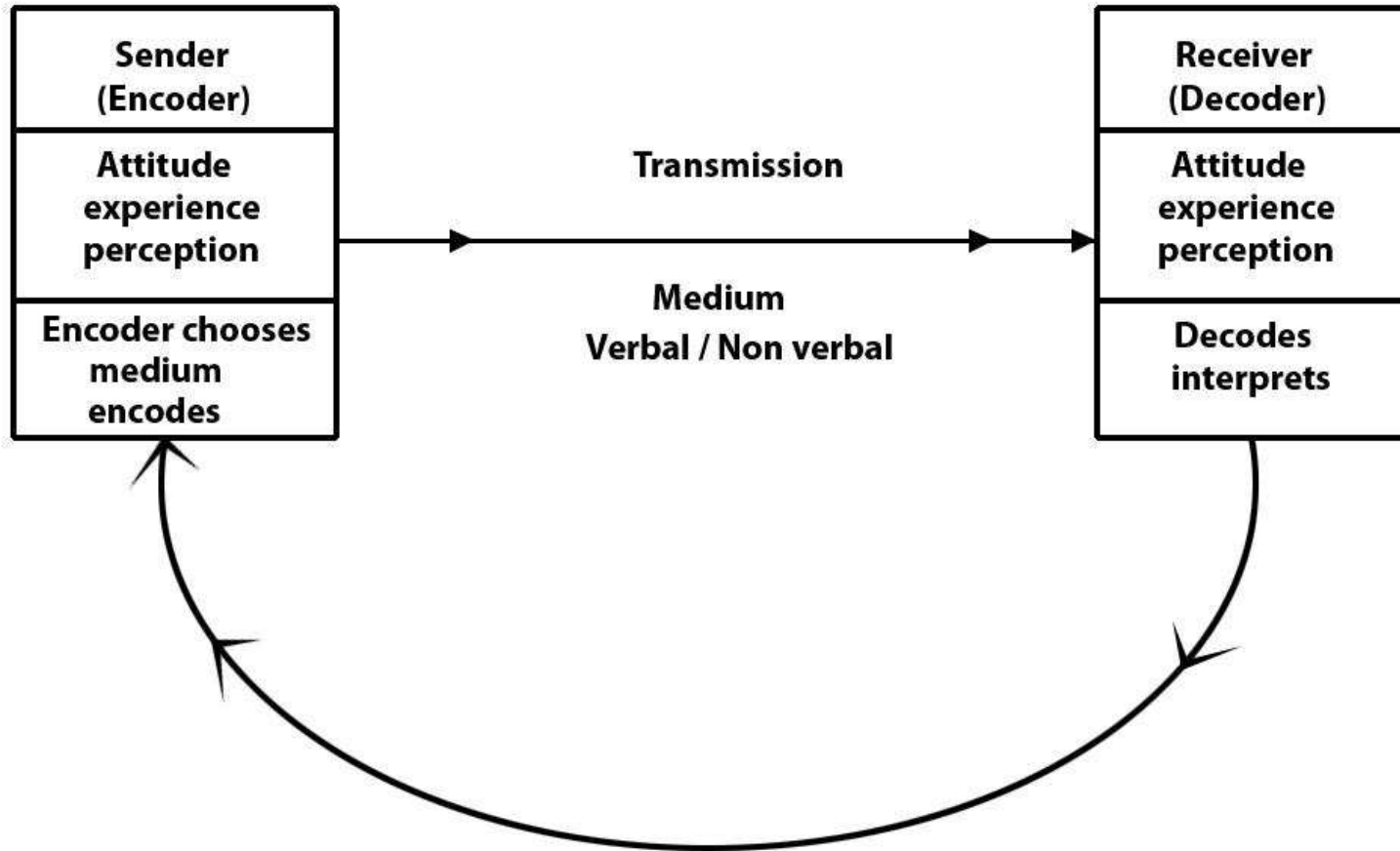
Lecture 4

What is communication?

- Communication is a word derived from the Latin word communis or commūnicāre, which means “to make common” or “to share”. Communication is the act of conveying intended meaning to another person through the use of mutually understood signs and language.
- Communication is the art of transmitting information, ideas and attitudes from one person to another. Communication is the process of meaningful interaction among human beings. The basic steps of communication are the forming of communicative intent, message composition, message encoding, and transmission of signal, reception of signal, message decoding and finally interpretation of the message by the recipient.
- Communication is simply the act of transferring information from one place to another. When you call or talk verbally to your friend, then you are said to be communicating with your friend.



Process of Communication or Communication loop



Characteristics of Communication



- **The characteristics of communication include:**
- **1. Communication is a process:** Communication is a 2-way process which involves; listening to others (Receiving) message Asserting/Expressing (Sending).
- **2. Communication is a dynamic:** it is ever changing depending on the variables at play.
- **3. Communication is a complex a process.**
- **4. Communication is a two-way process** of reaching mutual understanding, in which participants not only exchange (encode-decode) information but also create and share meaning.
- **5. Communication involves the sharing of information using a code.**
- **6. Communication occurs between people and sometimes animals.**
- **7. Communication is irreversible:** once one has communicated something it cannot be recalled back.
- **8. Communication is a system**
- **9. Communication must have the elements** of communication: Source, receiver, channel, message, noise, feedback.
- **10. Communication can be verbal/ nonverbal or visual.**
- **11. Communication can be accidental especially in non-verbal**

Functions/Importance of communication



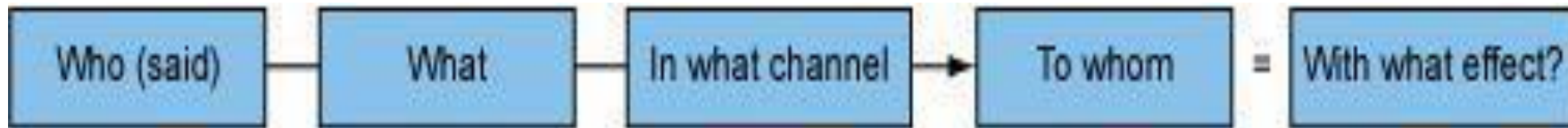
-
- Human beings communicate for various reasons. Here are some of the reasons why we must communicate:
 - 1. To change in behavior
 - 2. To influence others
 - 3. To express our thoughts and emotions through words & actions.
 - 4. It is a tool for controlling and motivating people.
 - 5. It is a social and emotional process.
 - 6. Communication for improving self-confidence
 - 7. Entertain
 - 8. Educate
 - 9. Establish relationships
 - 10. Inform
 - 11. Solve problems
 - 12. Make orders
 - 13. Give directions

MODELS OF COMMUNICATION

- The purpose of a “model” is to offer a visual representation of a concept with the intent of facilitating its understanding. Models of communication refer to the conceptual model used to explain the human communication process.
- The first major model for communication came in 1949 by Shannon and Warren Weaver. Following the basic concept, communication is the process of sending and receiving messages or transferring information from one part (sender) to another (receiver).
- Traditionally speaking, there are three standard models of the communication process: **Linear**, **Interactive**, and **Transactional**, and each offers a slightly different perspective on the communication process.

Linear Model

- The linear model views communication as a one-way or linear process in which the speaker speaks and the listener listens. Laswell's (1948) model was based on the five questions below, which effectively describe how communication works:



The main flaw in the linear model is that it depicts communication as a one-way process where speakers only speak and never listen. It also implies that listeners listen and never speak or send messages.

One-Way Communication



In one-way communication, information is transferred in one direction only, from the sender to the receiver. There isn't any opportunity for the receiver to give feedback to the sender.



One-way communication is frequently used when the sender wants to give factual information or when they want to persuade or manipulate their audience and gain their cooperation.



e.g: Bob is going out of town on a weekend business trip this morning. He wants his secretary to order lunch for the executive board meeting next week. As Bob heads out the door, he jots down a note for his secretary and leaves it on her desk.



The model of one-way communication looks like this:
Sender (Bob)-----> Message (Order lunch) -----> Receiver (Secretary)

1- Lack of Feedback

- There are numerous instances in which one-way communication eliminates opportunities for important feedback. Employee evaluations should include two-way conversations rather than just one-way performance assessments, **for example, according to the Robert Half company. In a traditional review, a manager shares scores and advise with employees. This scenario eliminates opportunities for the employee to assess his own performance and for the manager to gain insights on how to properly motivate him.**
- In a work team with strong experts , a manager who applies only one-way communication will **struggle** to draw out new ideas and discussion among team members on the merits of those ideas.

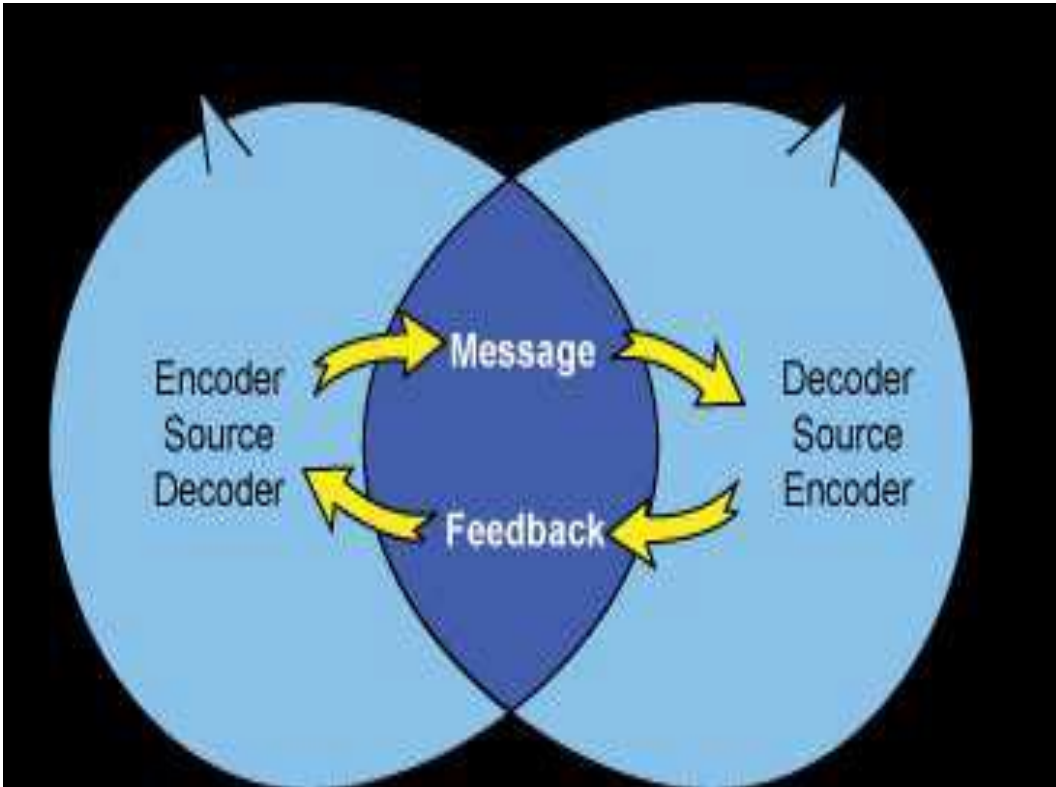
2- Harm Employee Morale

- A major indirect pitfall of only using one-way communication is the potential for damaged employee morale. When workers DON'T have the ability to share insights or feedback, they may feel stifled, inhibited and unappreciated.

Disadvantages of one-way communication

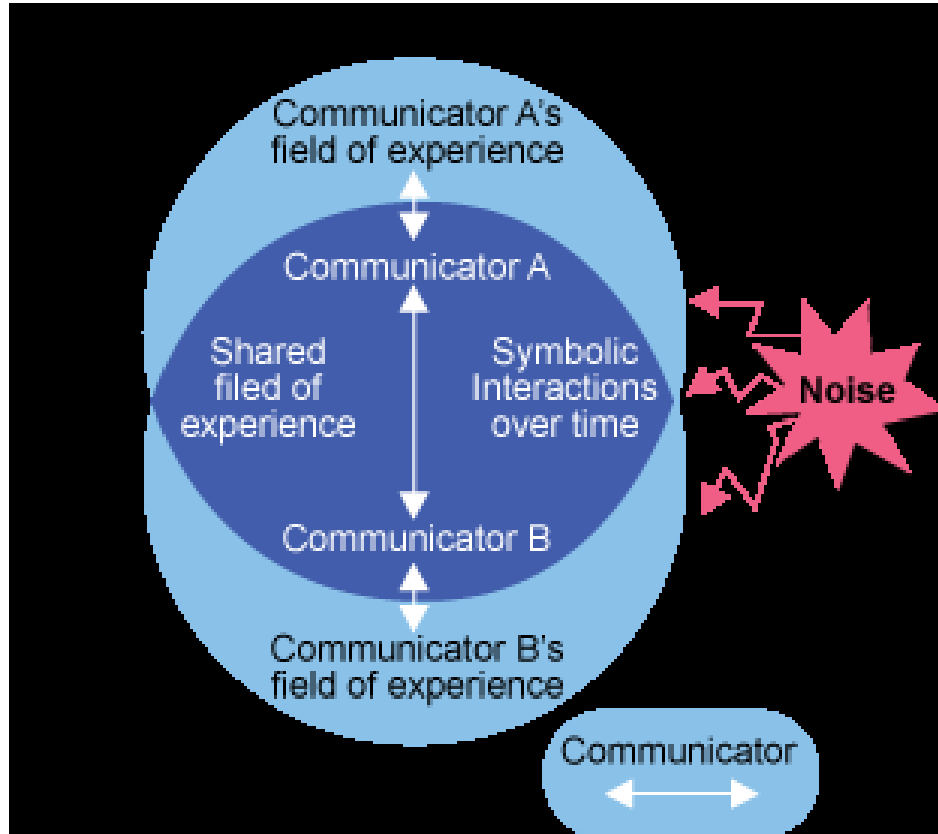


Interactive Model

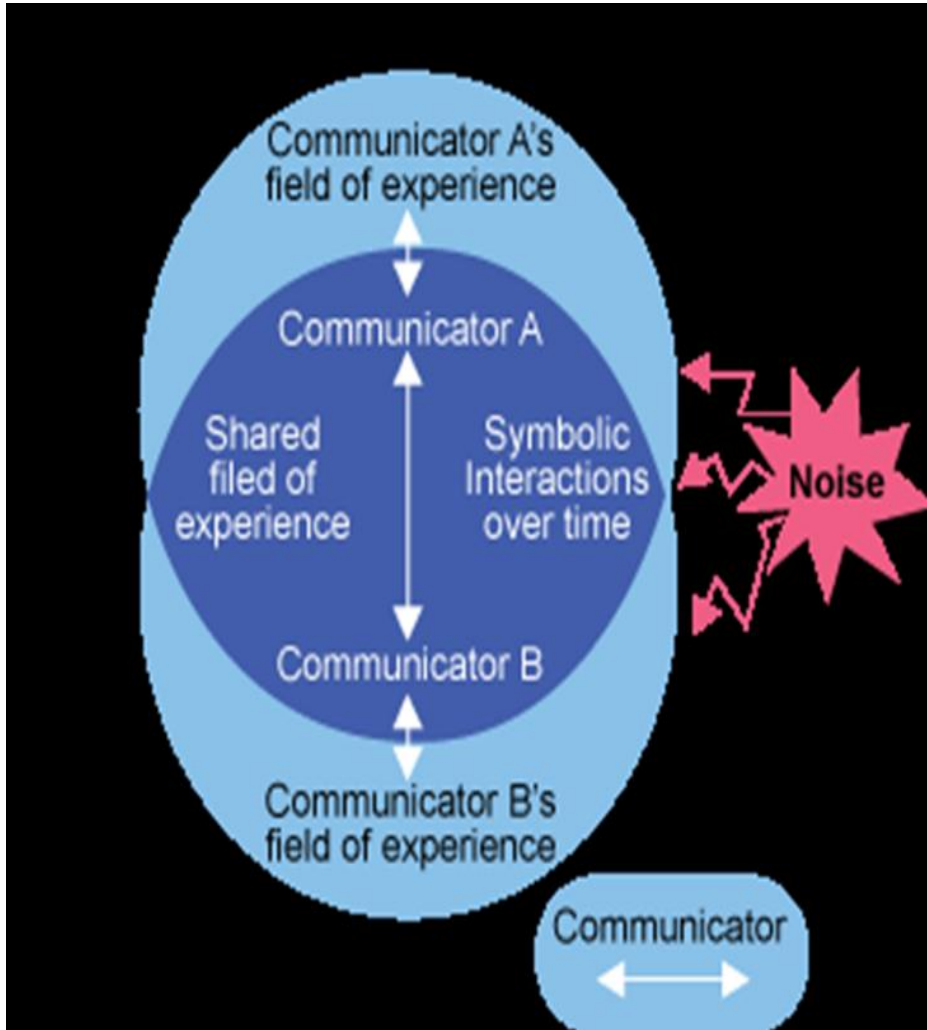


- Schramm (1955) in Wood (2009) came out with a more interactive model that saw the receiver or listener providing feedback to the sender or speaker **ALTERNATELY**.
- The speaker or sender of the message also listens to the feedback given by the receiver or listener.
- Both the speaker and the listener take turns to speak and listen to each other. Feedback is given either verbally or non-verbally, or in both ways.
- This model also indicates that the speaker and listener communicate better if they have common fields of experience, or fields which overlap
- The main drawback in the interactive model is that it does **NOT** indicate that communicators can both send and receive messages **SIMULTANEOUSLY**.
- This model also fails to show that communication is a dynamic process which changes over time.

Transactional Model



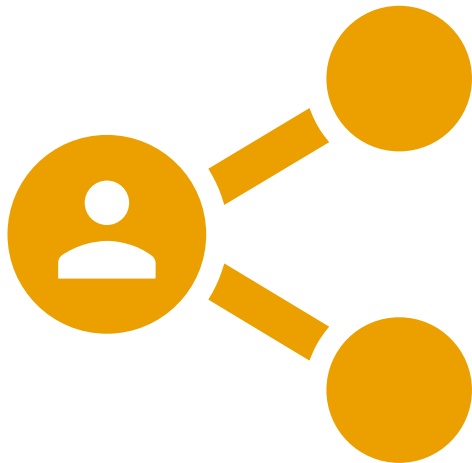
- The transactional model shows that the elements in communication are interdependent. Each person in the communication act is both a **speaker and a listener** and can be **SIMULTANEOUSLY sending and receiving** messages. There are three implications in the transactional model:
- i. “**Transactional**” means that communication is an **ongoing** and continuously changing process. **You** are changing, the **people** with whom you are communicating are changing, and your **environment** is also continually changing as well.
- ii. In any transactional process, each element exists in relation to all the other elements.
- iii. Each person in the communication process reacts depending on factors such as their **background, prior experiences, attitudes, cultural beliefs** and **self-esteem**.



Transactional Model

- Transactional model of communication takes into account **“noise”** or interference in communication as well as the **time** factor. The outer lines of the model indicate that communication happens within systems that both communicators share (e.g., a common campus, hometown, and culture) or personal systems (e.g., family, religion, friends, etc).
- It also takes into account changes that happen in the communicators’ fields of personal and common experiences. The model also labels each communicator as both sender as well as receiver simultaneously.

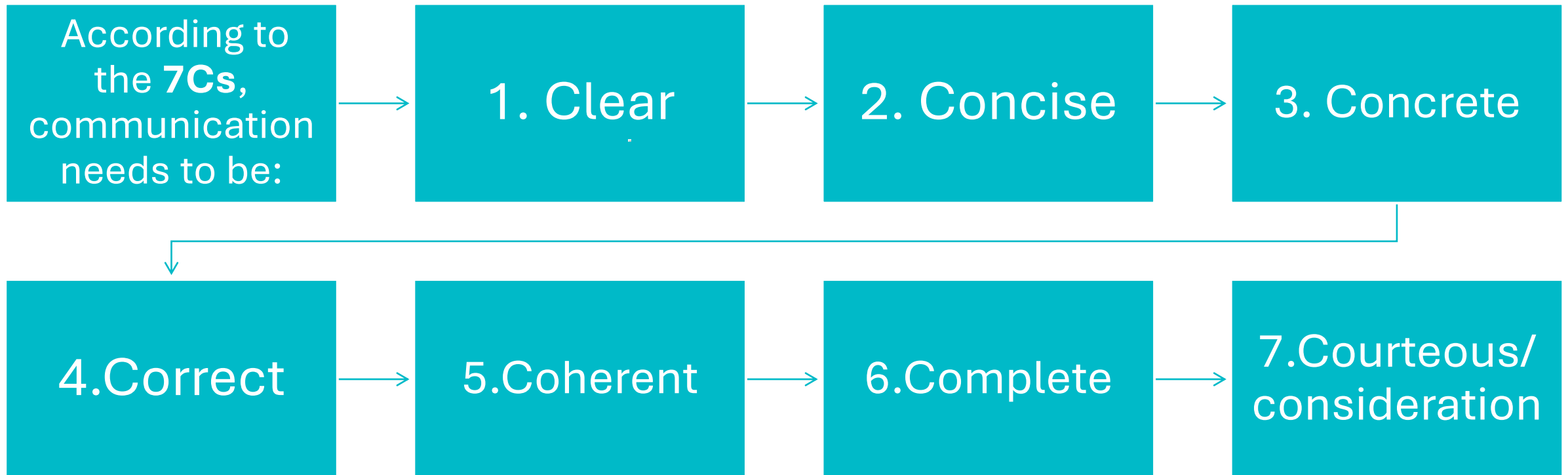
Two-way communication



-
- Two-way communication is a form of transmission in which both parties involved transmit information. Two-Way communication has also been referred to as interpersonal communication.
 - Common forms of two-way communication are:
 - - CB or FRS radio contacts.
 - - Chat rooms and Instant Messaging.
 - - Computer networks .
 - - In-person communication.
 - -Telephone conversations.
 - **Advantages of two-way communication**
 - 1. Allows instant feedback
 - 2. Seeking for clarification and interaction between sender and receiver is possible.
 - 3. Communication is quick and effective.

The 7 Cs of Communication

The 7 Cs provide a checklist for making sure that your meetings, emails, conference calls, reports, and presentations are well constructed and clear so your audience gets your message.



7Cs of Communication

- **1. Clear**

- When writing or speaking to someone, be clear about your **goal** or message. What is your purpose in communicating with this person? If you're not sure, then your audience won't be sure either.
- To be clear, try to **minimize** the number of ideas in each sentence. Make sure that it's easy for your reader to understand your meaning.
- People shouldn't have to “read between the lines” and make assumptions on their own to understand what you're trying to say.

- **2. Concise**

- When you are concise in your communication, you **stick to the point** and keep it brief.
- Your audience doesn't want to read six sentences when you could communicate your message in three.



7Cs of Communication



- **3. Concrete**

When your message is concrete, then your audience has a clear picture of what you're telling them. There are details (but not too many!) and vivid facts. Your message is solid. Look at these two examples:

For Example:

- a) The Lunchbox Wizard will save you time every day.
- b) How much time do you spend every day packing your kids' lunches? No more! Just take a complete Lunchbox Wizard from your refrigerator each day to give your kids a healthy lunch AND have more time to play or read with them!

7Cs of Communication

- **4. Correct**

When your communication is correct, it fits your audience. And correct communication is also error free communication.

- **5. Coherent**

When your communication is coherent, it's logical. All points are connected and relevant to the main topic, and the tone and flow of the text is consistent.

- **6. Complete**

In a complete message, the audience has everything they need to be informed and, if applicable, take action.

Does your message include a **“call to action”**, so that your audience clearly knows what you want them to do? Have you included all relevant information – contact names, dates, times, locations, and so on?



7Cs of Communication



-
- **7.Courteous/consideration**
 - Courteous communication is **friendly, open, and honest** and does not illicit emotions. There are no hidden insults or passive aggressive tones.
 - You keep your reader's viewpoint in mind, and you're **empathetic** to their needs. You must always **put yourself in the shoes of the person** you are talking to and ask yourself how you would feel if you were to be addressed the way you are addressing your receiver.
 - Consideration in communication creates a healthy work environment.